

6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577

Historical Farming, Agricultural Use and Land-Clearing Evidence Summary

Date: 30 April 2026 | Property reviewed: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale NSW 2577; Lot 4 DP746930.

Executive conclusion. Based on the material reviewed, the evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within the historic Bong Bong / Bulwer-Lytton Road locality, an area recorded in Austermere Estate material as cleared, ploughable and suitable for agricultural, dairy, orchard and farming use by 1904. The contract of sale provides the modern title and map bridge connecting 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930 to that older locality.

Scope Reviewed

This summary reviews the exchanged contract of sale, the title search and plans inside that contract, the planning certificate, NSW Cadastre data queried for Lot 4 DP746930, the 1904 Austermere Estate sale material, State Library subdivision-plan references, and previously located historical sources. It focuses on evidence that may support prior farming, agricultural use, grazing, orchard/dairy use, or historical clearing of the land.

Key Findings

Finding	Evidence / source	Strength
The modern property is Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Contract page 43 title search: Folio 4/746930, Lot 4 in DP746930, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Strong for legal identity.
DP746930 was created by subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 in 1987.	Contract scanned plan page 44: DP746930, "Subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513", Moss Vale, Bong Bong, Camden.	Strong for parent-title bridge.
The land is in the Bulwer Road / Lytton Road area.	Contract plan page 44 shows Lytton Road and road-widening context. NSW Cadastre polygon for Lot 4 DP746930 places the parcel beside Bulwer Road and north of Lytton Road.	Strong for location.
Austermere Estate material records agricultural/farming suitability and clearing by 1904.	NLA 1904 Austermere Estate plan and catalogue record describe land as "large area cleared & ready for plough" and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms.	Strong for wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality; not yet direct title-chain proof for Lot 4.
The contract does not directly say Lot 4 itself was farmed.	Search/OCR of contract text, title search, scanned Gazette pages and annexures found title/easement/planning material but no direct phrase such as "Lot 4 was farmed" or "cleared for agriculture".	Important limitation.

Contract Review

The contract is useful mainly as a title and location document. It identifies the sale land as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale, part of Lot 4 DP746930, with a proposed unregistered subdivision. The prescribed documents include title search material, an unregistered plan, the current deposited plan, older easement/title documents, Crown purchase-related material, and the 2023 planning certificate.

Relevant contract references:

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 1	Identifies the property as 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale; Lot 2 in an unregistered plan, part of Lot 4 DP746930; Part Folio Identifier 4/746930.	Confirms modern property identity.
Page 4	List of prescribed documents includes old system document and Crown purchase statement of account.	Shows deeper historical title material may exist beyond the bundle.

Relevant Contract References

Contract page	Observation	Use for farming/clearing question
Page 43	Title search confirms Lot 4 DP746930 at Moss Vale, Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.	Connects land to historical parish/county records.
Page 44	DP746930 plan shows subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513, registered in 1987, with Lytton Road and surrounding road geometry.	Gives key parent-title step before the modern lot.
Pages 232-248	Planning certificate confirms current E4 General Industrial zoning and that agriculture/farm buildings are prohibited under current zoning.	Current zoning does not prove historic use.

Historical Land Use Context

The 6 Bulwer Road locality sits within the wider Bong Bong/Moss Vale rural landscape. Heritage NSW records Throsby Park as the surviving core of a 1,000-acre grant made to Dr Charles Throsby in 1819, placing the area in an early colonial pastoral-estate context. The surrounding landscape was progressively cleared and used for grazing, farming and later rural holdings.

The modern parcel remained a large cleared landholding of about 8.6 hectares, consistent with rural-residential, hobby-farming, grazing, horse keeping or similar low-intensity agricultural use. Later planning material for nearby North-West Moss Vale land records a transition from rural landscape holdings toward large-lot residential/environmental living outcomes.

Historical Farming / Clearing Evidence

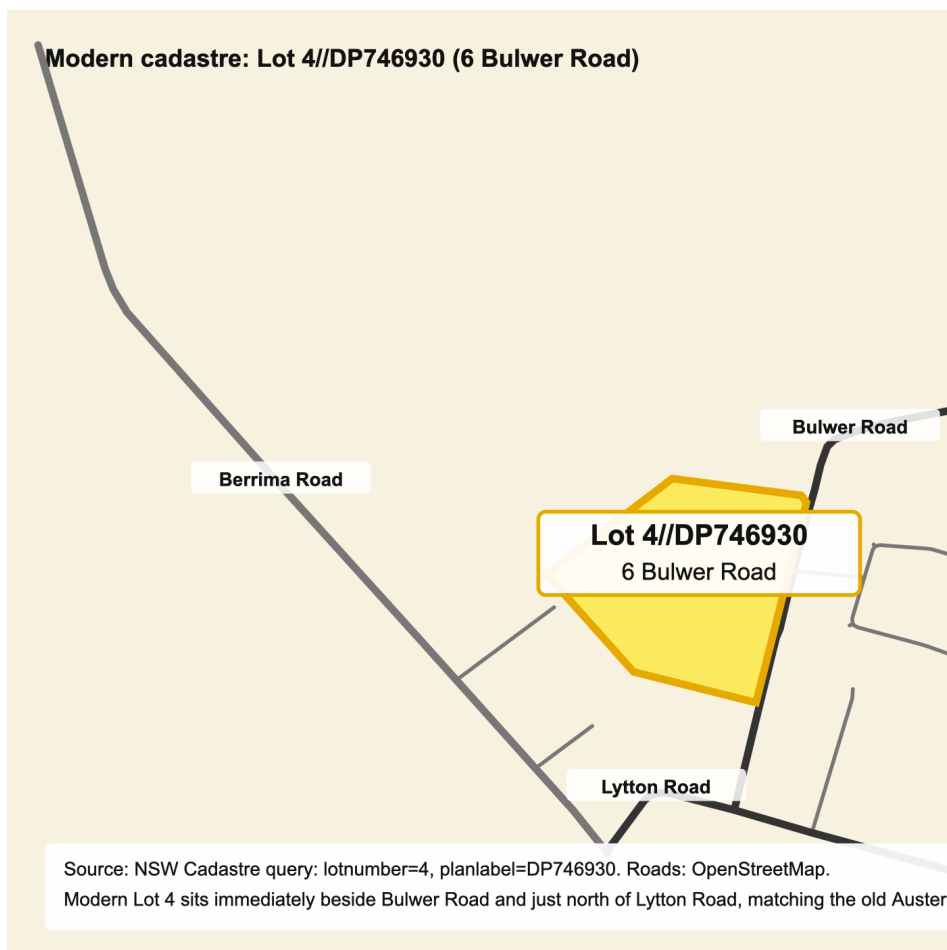
The best direct historical evidence remains the Austermere Estate sale material. The 1904 sale plan for Moss Vale Austermere Estate describes the estate as including a 'large area cleared & ready for plough' and markets the land for residential sites, orchard blocks, dairy and agricultural farms. This supports a defensible 'cleared by at least 1904' position for the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality.

Evidence Strength Matrix

Evidence item	What the evidence supports
Contract title search	Confirms the legal identity of the land as Lot 4 DP746930 in the Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden.
DP746930 plan	Shows modern Lot 4 was created from Lot 2 DP580513 and places the land around the Lytton/Bulwer Road area.
NSW Cadastre overlay	Places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road, aligning the modern parcel with the historical Bulwer/Lytton locality.
Austermere 1904 material	Records the wider locality as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farming by 1904.
Historical aerial imagery	Shows open paddock character, rural ground features and later disturbance periods across the subject parcel/surrounding locality.

Visual Exhibit A: Modern Cadastre Overlay

NSW Cadastre data queried for lotnumber=4 and planlabel=DP746930 places Lot 4 beside Bulwer Road and just north of Lytton Road.



Note: visual prepared from NSW Cadastre Feature Layer geometry and OpenStreetMap road geometry for orientation.

Source: Contract plan material for DP746930 / Lot 4.

[illegible]

Austermere Estate 1904 - Original Listing Evidence

Source: National Library of Australia, Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904. NLA object nla.obj-230332818.

The full original 1904 Austermere Estate sale listing is shown vertically so the whole listing and plan can be viewed together. The material promotes 'Orchard Blocks, Dairy & Agricultural Farms' and records a 'large area cleared & ready for plough', supporting agricultural use, land clearing and farming suitability in the wider Austermere/Bulwer-Lytton locality by 1904.

MOSS VALE AUSTERMERE ESTATE

Well known as the Property of the late Sir John Lackey 4000 ACRES

**Within 25 Chains of
MOSSVALE RAILY STN.**

Bong Bong Raily Plat^{fm} on the Estate

5 Miles of River frontage

Frontages to Railway Line also to BOWRAL & BERRIMA Main Roads

**UNDULATING Land, Good Soil,
well watered, Large area cleared &
ready for plough. Residential Sites
Orchard Blocks, Dairy & Agricultural farms.**

AUCTION SALE

SATURDAY

at 2.00.

26th NOVEMBER

1904

TORRENS' TITLE

TERMS

40 per cent Deposit,
5 per cent in 6 Months,
Balance by ten 1/2 yearly payments,
with 5 per cent Interest,
with right to pay off at any time.

REASONABLE PRICES

RICHARDSON & WRENCH LTD.

Auctioneers 98 Pitt St. Sydney

with ANDREW D. BADGERY

Auctioneer Moss Vale

TOWN OF
MOSS VALE

DIAGRAM

ATCHISON & SCHLEICHER

Licensed Surveyors
Specially licensed Under R. & P. & Mining Acts
Edwin Chambers 32 Pitt Street Sydney

William Brooks & Co. LIA. SYDNEY.

VENDORS

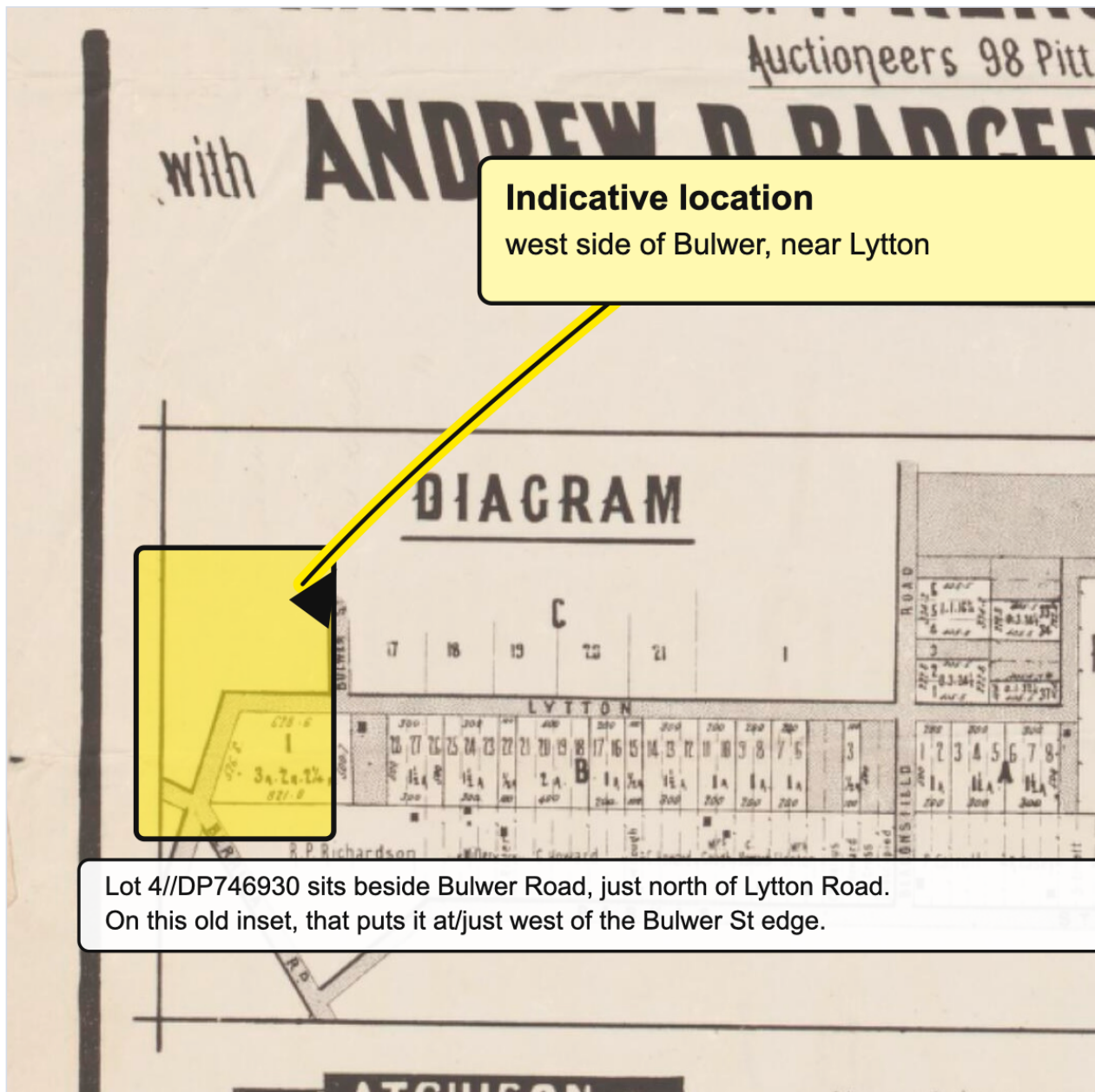
THE INTERCOLONIAL INVESTMENT
LAND & BUILDING COMPANY LTD
14 Moore St. SYDNEY G. P. O.
W. J. Douglas Manager

All measurements & Areas subject to Dep. Plans

Visual Exhibit: Austermere Indicative Location

This exhibit reinstates the earlier Austermere map location view. It is an indicative visual guide only, showing the approximate Bulwer/Lytton locality relationship on the Austermere Estate material against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location context.

Source: NLA Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904; indicative location annotation prepared from title/map comparison.



Sources Reviewed

- Exchanged Contract for Sale: 6 Bulwer Road, Moss Vale.
- NSW LRS Title Search within contract, Folio 4/746930.
- NSW Cadastre data queried for Lot 4 DP746930 and lotnumber/planlabel.
- National Library of Australia: Moss Vale Austermere Estate sale plan, 1904.
- National Library of Australia catalogue records for Austermere Estate / Moss Vale promotional subdivision material.
- State Library NSW Moss Vale subdivision plans list.
- NSW Spatial Services Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

Summary Position

Based on the evidence reviewed, the land at 6 Bulwer Road is strongly associated with a locality historically used and promoted for farming and agricultural purposes. The modern title and deposited plan place the land in the Parish of Bong Bong and in the Bulwer/Lytton Road area. The Austermere Estate material for this same historical locality records land as cleared, ready for ploughing, and suitable for orchard, dairy and agricultural farms by 1904.

Caveat

This report is an evidence summary prepared from available documents and public research material. It is not legal advice, a registered survey, a contamination assessment, or a formal historical land-use assessment. A solicitor, surveyor, environmental consultant or title search specialist should be engaged if the conclusions are to be used for legal, planning, financing or environmental due diligence purposes.

Parish Map and Crown Plan Review Addendum

This addendum reviews digitised Parish of Bong Bong maps and the contract title/plan material to help assess whether the 6 Bulwer Road locality was historically rural, agricultural, farmed or cleared for farming purposes.

Summary finding. The 1942 and 1968 Parish of Bong Bong maps support the view that the Bulwer/Lytton Road locality sat within a broader rural cadastral landscape made up of large acreages and named holdings rather than modern industrial lots. This adds support to the farming/agricultural history already shown in the 1904 Austermere material.

Map Sources Reviewed

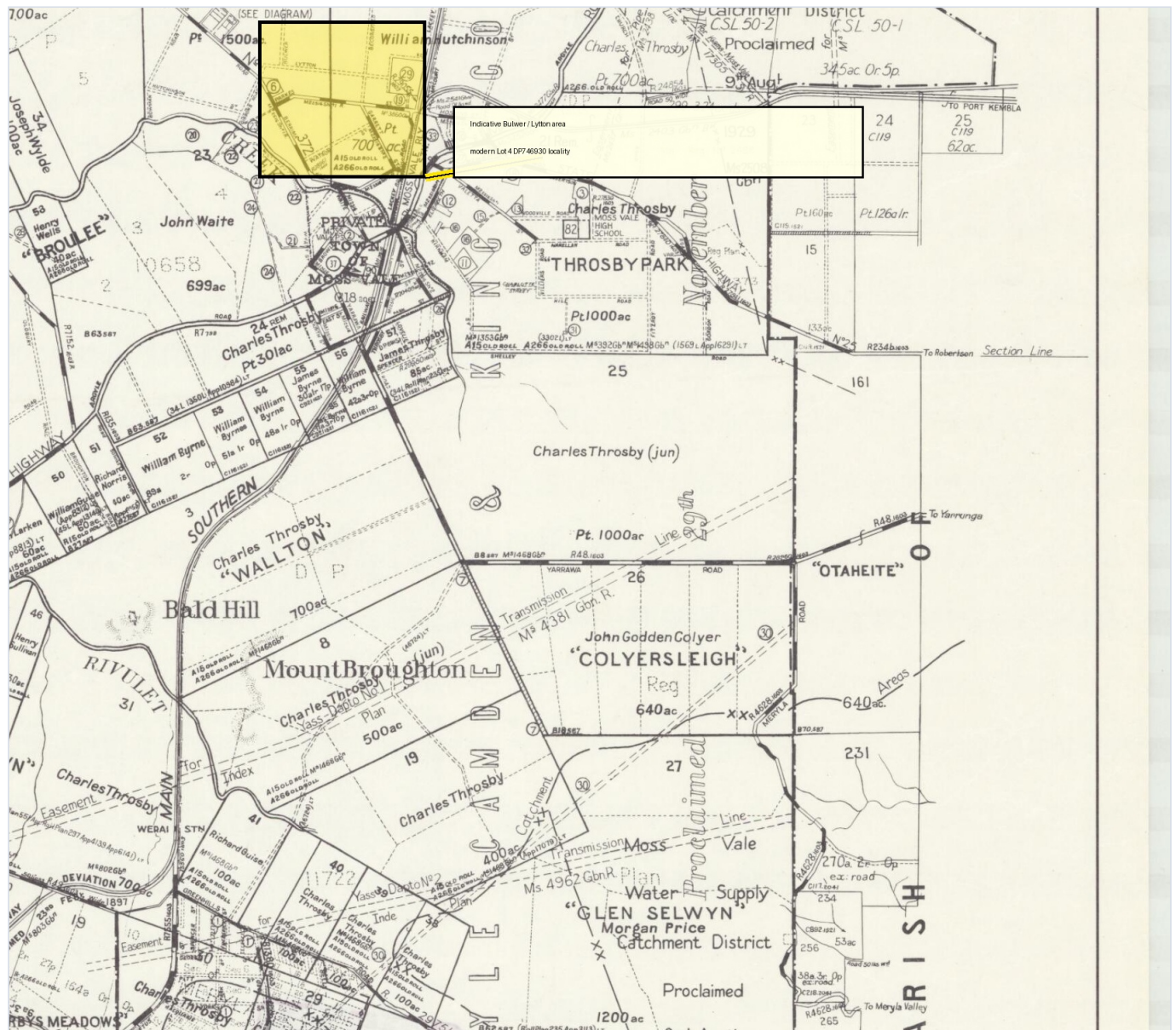
Source	Relevant details	Relevance
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1942, 8th edition	Department of Lands parish map. Shows Moss Vale, Bong Bong parish, large rural holdings, road alignments and parish numbers used schedule.	Confirms rural parish mapping context.
Parish of Bong Bong, County of Camden, 1968, 9th edition	Department of Lands parish map. Catalogue notes it is a cadastral map showing parish boundaries and land holdings.	Shows continuing rural/parish landholding context.
Contract DP746930 plan	Shows DP746930 was a subdivision of Lot 2 DP580513 and places the modern parcel in the Lytton/Bulwer road area.	Provides bridge needed to compare with parish map location.

Parish Map Observations

- The Parish of Bong Bong maps show Moss Vale in the context of older parish portions, old roll references and large acreages rather than dense modern lots.
- Nearby landholdings include names associated with the broader historical rural landscape, including Hutchinson, John Waite, Charles Throsby and others.
- The indicative Bulwer/Lytton position sits beside the older Moss Vale township and adjacent to large-acreage parish land.
- The maps do not themselves state “cleared for agriculture”, but their landholding pattern is consistent with the surrounding historical evidence of rural/agricultural use.

Indicative Parish Map Extract

The highlighted area below is an indicative Bulwer/Lytton locality position on the 1968 Parish of Bong Bong map, used for orientation against the modern Lot 4 DP746930 location. It is not a surveyed overlay.



Historical Aerials

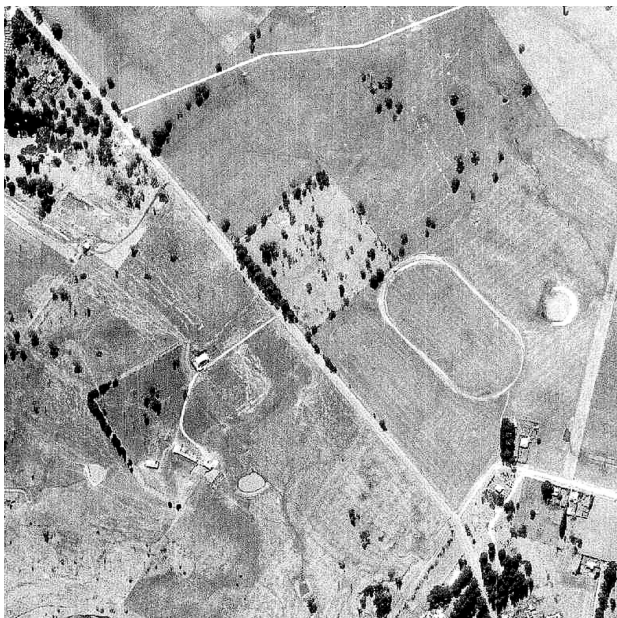
Source: NSW Spatial Services - Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

The aerial extracts below are ordered from earliest to latest. The views are clean cropped extracts with no survey-style pinpoint markers shown.

Historical aerial imagery sourced from NSW Spatial Services shows repeated cleared paddock areas, access tracks and an oval/circular ground feature near 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4 DP746930. Later colour frames show the oval feature most clearly; earlier black-and-white frames are included as locality and disturbance evidence.

Corrected view: 19/08/1963 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 29/12/1974 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



1963 and 1974 revised clean aerial extracts. No pinpoint marker is shown.

Historical Aerials

Source: NSW Spatial Services - Historical Imagery Viewer / Historical Aerial Photography collection.

1979, 1989, 1991 and 1997 revised clean aerial extracts, ordered earliest to latest.

Corrected view: 08/01/1979 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 25/02/1989 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 23/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 24/09/1991 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Corrected view: 21/01/1997 - 6 Bulwer Road / Lot 4

Clean extract for visual orientation; not a surveyed overlay.



Final image retained on the same page and widened slightly for context.